

Routledge
Taylor & Francis Group

Journal of Relationship Marketing

ISSN: 1533-2667 (Print) 1533-2675 (Online) Journal homepage: https://www.tandfonline.com/loi/wjrm20

The Role of Trust in Understanding the Impact of Social Media Marketing on Brand Equity and Brand Loyalty

Reham Shawky Ebrahim

To cite this article: Reham Shawky Ebrahim (2019): The Role of Trust in Understanding the Impact of Social Media Marketing on Brand Equity and Brand Loyalty, Journal of Relationship Marketing, DOI: 10.1080/15332667.2019.1705742

To link to this article: https://doi.org/10.1080/15332667.2019.1705742

Published online: 26 Dec 2019.

Submit your article to this journal

Article views: 11

View related articles

View Crossmark data

Full Terms & Conditions of access and use can be found at
https://www.tandfonline.com/action/journalInformation?journalCode=wjrm20

JOURNAL OF RELATIONSHIP MARKETING
https://doi.org/10.1080/15332667.2019.1705742

Routledge
Taylor & Francis Group

The Role of Trust in Understanding the Impact of Social Media Marketing on Brand Equity and Brand Loyalty

Reham Shawky Ebrahim

Business Administration, Faculty of Commerce, Tanta University, Tanta, Egypt

ABSTRACT

In this era, social media platform is integrated into the marketing strategy. This new technology sets out new mechanisms and communication tools that companies can rely on to interact and engage with actual and potential customers. This study aimed at exploring the impact of social media marketing activities (SMM) on brand loyalty via brand trust and brand equity. Based on an online survey of 287 users who follow telecommunications companies on social media located in Egypt, data was collected and analyzed using structural equation modeling. The results revealed that SMM activities comprise only three dimensions; trendiness, customization and word-of-mouth. These attributes of social media marketing directly influence brand loyalty and indirectly influence brand equity mediated by brand trust. The study emphasis the role of trust and provide guidance toward measuring the effectiveness of social media marketing.

KEYWORDS

Social media marketing; brand trust; brand loyalty; brand equity; brand loyalty

Introduction

The proliferation of social media has significantly changed the marketing practices. This quickly expanding marketing channel on social media, that accesses 2.77 billion internet users around the world, has redefined new ways for companies to reach, interact and engage with customers. Companies are investing in technology to enhance their social media presence, in the next five years marketers are expecting to expand social media spend by 71 percent of marketing budget (CMO, 2018). They are adding social media as an integral part to the marketing strategies, and perceive it as a less costly platform on which marketers can perform integrated marketing activities with minimum efforts (Kim & Ko, 2010).

Social media marketing (SMM) is the augmentation to traditional and digital marketing communication tools (Tuten & Solomon, 2017), which monitors and facilitates customer communications, collaborations and interactions with the company, its brands and other customers, and

CONTACT Reham Ebrahim rsh.ebrahim@yahoo.co.uk Business Administration, Faculty of Commerce, Tanta University, Said St. Tanta Qism 2, EL GHARBEYA، Gharbia Governorate, Tanta, Egypt.

© 2019 Taylor & Francis Group, LLC

encourages their engagement. It also describes customers' view of the company's multiple marketing activities on the social media platform (Yadav & Rahman, 2018). SMM is a challenge to marketing managers, that can be used as a powerful driver to customers' responses that can positively influence their intentions, behaviors, and purchase decisions (Chen & Lin, 2019; Dann, 2010) and a major factor in brand building and creating long-term customer relationship (Kim & Ko, 2010; Sano, 2014). The social media offer various opportunities and benefits for successful brand management, a major challenge is measuring the impact of marketing managers practices on social media (Godey et al., 2016; Schultz & Peltier, 2013). Kim and Ko (2010) identify five major forces: interaction, entertainment, trendiness, customization and word-of-mouth, that captures engaging consumers' perceptions of various marketers' practices on social media and characterizes social media marketing activities (Yadav & Rahman, 2018). These activities stimulate consumers' experiences and will have impacts on the brand equity and subsequent purchase intentions and behaviors (Chen & Lin, 2019). In the context of social media, consumer responses toward various interactions are subject to trust; that plays a significant role in delivering the impact of online activities and translating marketers' efforts to equity and loyalty (Tatar & Eren-Erdogmus, 2016; Warner-Søderholm et al., 2018).

Despite the growing stream of studies on social media; however, to date the study of the impact of such practices on brand value and customer relationships is still concealed (Seo & Park, 2018). Previous studies on social media can be categorized into four main categories: brand communities, E-WOM, network analysis, and product-harm crises (Gensler, Völckner, Liu-Thompkins, & Wiertz, 2013). Alalwan, Rana, Dwivedi, and Algharabat (2017) divided these groups into subgroups including: first, studies addressing the role of social media in predicting advertising activities, second, studies examined the role of social media in customer-relationship management, third, the studies that analyze the impact of the informative role of social media on consumer behavior, fourth, research focus on the factors influencing customer adoption of social group, and finally the studies that focus on social media from the perspective of organizations. Therefore, there is still a lack of studies that examine social media marketing from the perspectives of branding literature (Godey et al., 2016).

Accordingly, this study addresses the gap in the literature and investigates the effects of social media marketing activities and consumer positive behavioral responses toward the brand, in particular brand equity and loyalty.

This paper is organized as follows: the next section is a discussion of the literature review to define the meaning of the main concepts. Then the

conceptual framework is proposed and the hypotheses are generated. The third section reviews the research methodology and the fourth section presents the results of the study. Finally, the last section includes the conclusion of the study, theoretical and practical implications, and the limitations of the study with avenues for future research.

Literature review

Social media marketing

Social media is defined as "*a group of internet-based applications that build on the ideological and technological foundations of Web 2.0, and that allow the creation and exchange of user generated content*." (Kaplan & Haenlein, 2010, p. 61). The strength of social media is derived from the platform of Web 2.0 that provides the technical infrastructure which facilitates the engagement of the user and enables the generation and distribution of content (Berthon, Pitt, Plangger, & Shapiro, 2012). In the online context, both social media and social networks are used interchangeably, however, there are differences between them. Social networking refers to the use of social media as a means to connect with people (Alalwan et al., 2017).

From this perspective social networks are conceived as the web-based services that allow an individual to (1) construct a public or semipublic profile within a bounded system, (2) formulate a list of users with whom he/she share a connection, and (3) view and traverse their list of connections and those made by others within the system (Boyd & Ellison, 2007). Social network is thus a channel in the community zone of social media that focuses on the collaboration, conversation, and sharing among users. Although all social media channels allow for networked relationship, however, interaction and collaboration ae the main theme of social network. The social network sites are the online hosts that allow members to create their own private profile such as Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn (Tuten & Solomon, 2017).

There are many forms of virtual existence on social network such as friendship between individuals, group communities, and business relations between companies. People going online are looking to share their experience and interests, build relations, and discuss ideas with others (Zaglia, 2013). The social network theory postulates that human behaviors are embedded in these online interpersonal relations (Granovetter, 1985), therefore, it is likely that the behaviors of members are influenced by social network practices (Valck, van Bruggen, & Wierenga, 2009). The speed of communication and the numerous information sources attract marketers to shift from traditional media to social media to create awareness and stimulate consumer preferences toward brands (Duffett, 2015). The utilization of

social media channels in the marketing context provides a new landscape for brand marketing communication; it gives power to consumers and offers a personal channel and link for user-generated content and social interaction (Chi, 2011).

Several attempts have been made to provide a definition of social media marketing, still no collective agreement has been reached, as illustrated in Table 1. Early in the literature, social media marketing was defined as "*brand communications placed in an online social networking context. It is characterized by social connectivity and user interactivity in the brand' attempt to communicate with its consumers and prospects*" (Chi, 2011, p. 48). Also, Dwivedi, Kapoor, and Chen (2015, p. 5) defined social media marketing as "*as a dialogue often triggered by consumers/audiences, or a business/product/service that travels in a circle amongst the stated parties to set in motion revealing communications on some promotional information, or to learn from one another's use experiences, eventually benefitting either or all of the involved parties*". Generally, social media marketing can be defined as the process that utilizes social media technologies and channels to create, communicate, and deliver marketing offerings that enhance the company's stakeholders' value (Tuten & Solomon, 2017; Yadav & Rahman, 2017, 2018).

From the different emerging definitions for social media marketing (SMM), it can be extrapolated that, firstly, SMM utilize the social media platform and use it as a marketing tool to create a two-way communication to engage with customers and deliver valuable offers thus gaining higher brand/product or services attention and encourage consumer participation, secondly, SMM enables interaction, content sharing and information diffusion (Chang, Yu, & Lu, 2015). Thirdly, SMM addresses user responses toward the brand or the social networking sites are ranging from beliefs or perceptions (Chi, 2011; Dwivedi et al., 2015), attitudinal responses such as satisfaction (Sano, 2014), or behavioral responses such as word-of-mouth, purchase intention and loyalty (Kim & Ko, 2012, 2010).

Therefore, social media marketing activities can be defined as effective marketing communication methods that capture engaged consumers' perceptions and understanding of activities on social media marketing by five dimensions namely; entertainment, interaction, trendiness, customization and word-of-mouth (Chen & Lin, 2019; Kim & Ko, 2010, 2012; Yadav & Rahman, 2018).

The forces of social media marketing have been addressed in a number of studies with various settings. Kim and Ko (2012) examine the relationship between SMM, drivers of customer equity namely; value equity, brand equity, and relationship equity, and purchase intention of luxury fashion brands. In this study, the SMM activities are identified as entertainment, customization, interaction, word-of-mouth, and trendiness. The results of

Table 1. Definitions of social media marketing.

Study	Social Media Marketing
(Felix, Rauschnabel, & Hinsch, 2017, p. 121)	"A pure communications tool to push content to customers, the community, or employees. This defender approach, which the informants did not generally recommend, typically focuses on one or a few stakeholder groups."
(Seo & Park, 2018)	"It allows companies to communicate with consumers easily and quickly. From the company perspective, their mere participation on social media generates positive effects to the same extent as traditional advertisements. Interactions with potential as well as existing customers enable companies to communicate positive brand images"
(Alalwan et al., 2017, p. 1179)	"A dialogue often triggered by consumers/audiences, or a business/product/services that circulate amongst the stated parties to set in motion a revealing communication on some promotional information so that it allows learning from one another's use and experiences, eventually benefitting all of the involved parties."
(Tuten & Solomon, 2017)	"Is the utilization of social media technologies, channels, and software to create, communicate, deliver, and exchange offerings that have value for an organization's stakeholders"
(Yadav & Rahman, 2017, p. 3; 2018)	"A process by which companies create, communicate, and deliver online marketing offerings via social media platforms to build and maintain stakeholder relationships that enhance stakeholders' value by facilitating interaction, information sharing, offering personalized purchase recommendations, and WOM creation among stakeholders about existing and trending products and services"
(Ismail, 2017, p. 137)	"Perceived social media marketing activities is an effective tool developing relationship with customers, and building brand loyalty within the social media-based brand community."
(Choi et al., 2016, p. 772)	"Engaging with customers through SNSs is commonly known as social media marketing and brings several benefits to companies, such as creating word-of-mouth, positively affecting customer equity, enhancing customer loyalty to the company, and increasing purchase intention of the company's products or services"
(Chang et al., 2015, p. 777)	"Social media marketing, which uses social networks such as Facebook to enable content sharing, information diffusion, relationship building, and fans cohesion"
(Pham & Gammoh, 2015, p. 325)	"Company's process of creating and promoting online marketing-related activities on social media platforms that offer values to its stakeholders"
(Chan & Guillet, 2011, p. 347)	"A social and managerial process by which individuals and groups obtain what they need and want through a set of Internet-based applications that enable interaction, communication, collaboration of user-generated content and hence, sharing of information such as ideas, thoughts, content, and relationships"
(Chi, 2011, p. 46)	"Social media marketing provides meaning and connection between brands and consumers and offers a personal channel and currency for user-centered networking and social interaction"
(Barefoot & Szabo, 2010, p. 13)	"A subset of online marketing activities that complete traditional web-based promotion strategies, such as e-mail newsletters and online advertising campaigns"
(Dann, 2010) (Chen & Lin, 2019)	"The commercial marketing events or processes that use social media in an attempt to positively influence consumers' purchase behavior"
(Taubenheim et al., 2008)	"A way of using the Internet to instantly collaborate, share information, and have a conversation about ideas or causes we care about"
(Tuten, 2008, p. 9)	"A broad category of advertising spending, including advertising using social network, virtual worlds, user-generated product reviews, blogger endorsement, RSS feeds of content and social news sites, podcasts, games, and consumer generated advertising"

the study revealed the positive impact of only three social media marketing activities; entertainment, interaction, and word-of-mouth on purchase intention through the customer equity drivers; value and brand equity. These dimensions of SMM of luxury brands were examined in different studies. In the same context of luxury fashion brand, Gautam and Sharma

(2017) support the mediating impact of customer relationship on SMM and purchase intention relationship (Mohammadpour, Arbatani, Gholipour, Farzianpour, & Hosseini, 2014). In the study of Godey et al. (2016), they assess the influence of SMM activities on brand awareness and brand image, and in turn their impact on consumer behavior. The findings support the significant influence of entrainment, interaction, and trendiness on both brand image and brand awareness. However, the results varied among different groups from different countries. Finally, the study supports the effect of SMM activities on building brand loyalty. The study of Bilgin (2018) examined also the relationship between SMM, brand awareness, brand image, and brand loyalty but on the five highly scored brands on social media in Turkey. This study supports the findings of Godey et al. (2016); however, it argues that SMM may not be effective enough to create a positive brand image in consumer's mind and enhance brand loyalty. Since consumers who are following brands on social media have a certain image in their minds and may even be loyal to it. However, Ismail (2017) reveals in his study that SMM activities can enhance customer's loyalty to the brand and influence the brand and value consciousness.

In different contexts of the the tourism industry, Sano (2014) addresses the impact of SMM activities on consumer attitudes and behaviors. The SMM were measured by four activities: interaction, trendiness, customization, and perceived risk. The results show that SMM activities, customization is the most important dimension, influence customer satisfaction which in turn has a great influence on purchase intention and word-of-mouth. This study also clarifies how SMM can impact consumer behaviors, illustrated by the behavioral intentions to buy or recommend the service. Social media increases the relations capital of companies via enhancing its relationship with customer which positively influence the purchasing intentions (Mohammadpour et al., 2014). Chan and Guillet (2011) investigated the reasons behind the poor performance of companies in doing social media marketing. Among these reasons are the lack of interactions between the companies and their guests, the inaccurate content and incorrect information posted on the social media sites and being unresponsive to customers, and the difficult accessibility. These factors not only lead to poor performance of the company but negatively affects its identity. The social media communication either generated by the firm or user the company enhances the brand image and the overall evaluation of the brand effectively than the traditional marketing tools such as advertising (Bruhn, Schoenmueller, & Schäfer, 2012).

Seo and Park (2018) added the dimension of entertainment to the four identified by (Sano, 2014) and assess the effects of SMM activities on brand equity and consumer responses, illustrated by electronic word-of-mouth and

commitment toward airlines. Their study supports the importance of the five activities; however, the relative importance was highest in trendiness followed by customization, and the significant impact on both brand awareness and brand image.

From prior studies it can be concluded that the dimensions of social media marketing activities are five: entertainment, interaction, customization, trendiness, and word-of-mouth (Gautam & Sharma, 2017; Godey et al., 2016; Kim & Ko, 2012; Mohammadpour et al., 2014). Entertainment represents the hedonic aspect; the fun and pleasure acquired from social media usage. The contribution of users to brands on social media platform is described by the dimension of interaction. Trendiness, represents the degree that the information provided through social media is new and up-to-date. Customization represents the extent to which the service satisfies different tastes of customers based upon their demands (Seo & Park, 2018). Word-of-mouth refers to the informal communications among users that hold opinion exchange and recommendations (Sano, 2014) This last dimension of word-of-mouth have been replaced with a perceived risk that refers to the ability to lessen consumers' concerns and anxiety (Seo & Park, 2018). While, Bilgin (2018) add advertisement to represent online advertising and promotional campaigns as an important component of social media marketing activities. Yadav and Rahman (2017) develop a scale to measure social media marketing activities in e-commerce industry and the dimension of entertainment was substituted by the informative attribute. It is worthwhile, that the relative importance of social media marketing activities is varied.

The role of social media marketing activities in increasing the brand awareness and creating a positive brand image, which in turn affect consumer loyalty has been investigated in a number of studies. However, these studies either focused on the luxury fashion industry or the tourism sector. Also, only a few studies investigated the direct impact of social media marketing activities on consumer responses and how it can change user's behavior.

Brand equity

Following the marketing view of brand equity, there are many definitions; however, there is a consensus among the definition of (Srivastava & Shocker, 1991) that brand equity is the incremental value of the brand. In the context of marketing decision-making based on consumer, customer-based brand equity is defined as "*the differential effect of brand knowledge on consumer response to the marketing if the brand*" (Keller, 1993, p. 8). Customer evaluates the brand equity through its strength or the brand

associations and value or the perceived brand utility relative to its costs. Customer's perceptions of the brand value influences its performance and increases the financial gains of the firm (Lassar, Mittal, & Sharma, 1995). As proposed by Keller (1993), brand equity is composed of four dimensions: brand awareness, brand image, brand associations, and perceived brand quality; however, this study focuses on the overall brand equity that assess the added value of the focal brand perceived by consumers relative to other brands (Yoo & Donthu, 2001).

Brand trust

The construct of trust involves a calculative process based on the role of an object to continually perform its role and the relationship between costs and rewards (Doney & Cannon, 1997). Brand trust is defined as the willingness of a consumer to rely on the ability of a brand to perform as entitled. It thus involves the benevolence of the firm to work in the best interest of its customer to enhance the facets of trust including safety, reliability, and reliability (Chaudhuri & Holbrook, 2001). In an uncertain environment, trust exists as an implicit set of beliefs that no one is taking advantage of the situation particularly when rules cannot guarantee others expected behavior. In virtual communities, the absence of workable rules raises the importance of trust (Ridings, Gefen, & Arinze, 2002).

In the online context, the role of trust; an individual's confidence, on the social media platform has been addressed in a number of studies. The personality characteristics and traits play an important role in individuals' perception of trust in the online context and accordingly shape their intentions and behaviors. Pentina, Zhang, and Basmanova (2013) assume that the match between user's personality and social media is related to trust in the site. the results of their study confirm that trust plays an important role on social media since it is related to users' behavioral responses such as intentions to continue using the social network in the future and recommend it to others.

In a very recent study by Warner-Søderholm et al. (2018), they proposed that users' perception of trust varies depending on their gender, age, and time spent on social media. The construct of trust is measured by five dimensions: benevolence, integrity, competence, identification, and concern. The findings suggest that user's perceptions of integrity; depict the ethical and moral ideologies held by a human, differs with regard to gender, age, and frequency of social media usage. Accordingly, female and young users have high expectations with integrity (Warner-Søderholm et al., 2018). This dimension of trust is related and used to assess affective trust that concerns with one's emotional ties and concern for the welfare of others. While,

cognitive trust focuses on the benefits over risks. The interaction orientation of social media fosters the affective trust more than traditional websites (Calefato, Lanubile, & Novielli, 2015). These communications either firm-created or user-generated increase brand trust and enhance the relationship with customers (Khadim, Hanan, Arshad, Saleem, & Khadim, 2018). However, in the tourism sector, Schmidt and Iyer (2015) assumes that consumers perceive brand communities as more trustworthy than the company's traditional public relations efforts. The firm-created content should be in line with the brand image, if the firm increasingly accommodates to the customer's language style, it will negatively affect trust (Jakic, Wagner, & Meyer, 2017).

The characteristics of online environment are also considered drivers of trust. In this essence, Kim and Park (2013) examine the mediating role of trust in the relationship between social commerce attributes and behavioral intentions. The study provides a support that users tend to trust social commerce if it provides a favorable online environment in terms of communication, reputation, transaction safety, size, information quality, and word-of-mouth referrals. Also, Tatar and Eren-Erdogmus (2016), examine the impact of social media marketing in the sector of tourism on brand trust and brand loyalty. The findings support that social media experience is an important driver of trust, this experience is assessed by a clear website, online interactivity, website security, and collaboration.

Khong et al. (2013) posit that trust on social media platform is also built through consumer empowerment or the presence of both psychological and structural conditions though users' perceptions of enhanced ability to share information and simply access and perform transactions on social media. Consumers share commonalities and information with others who are influencing their decisions and trust. Virtual communities are considered part of the network effect influencing trustworthiness and trust. Consumers have great trust on community members who are responsive and confiding information and personal experiences with others (Ridings et al., 2002). Social media is a platform where consumers are sharing personal information and experiences with others.

Brand loyalty

Early views of brand loyalty focus on the behavioral perspective; the purchasing pattern or the repurchasing probability (Srinivasan, Anderson, & Ponnavolu, 2002). However, this perspective solely cannot measure loyalty, the purchasing action is a misleading indication of loyalty. therefore, the other attitudinal aspect of loyalty is proposed to refer to consumer's

psychological predispositions including attitudes, preferences and commitment toward a brand. Therefore, attitudinal loyalty draws the factors underlying the biased behavior of repeat purchase (Tatar & Eren-Erdogmus 2016). Focusing on the two perspectives, brand loyalty is defined as the deeply held commitment toward rebuying the brand in the future regardless to the situational factors (Chaudhuri & Holbrook, 2001). Based upon this definition, the behavioral loyalty tends to lead to high market share, while the attitudinal loyalty leads to higher relative brand value (Taylor, Celuch, & Goodwin, 2004).

Several studies have addressed the drivers and consequences of brand loyalty in the online context (e.g., Khadim et al., 2018; Srinivasan et al., 2002; Tatar & Eren-Erdogmus 2016) The drivers of loyalty on the online environment are unlike the traditional or the offline context, it requires the firm to focus on several factors related to the online context such as connectivity, interactivity, customization, convenience or ease of use, cultivation or relevance of online information and community (Srinivasan et al., 2002).

Conceptual framework and development of hypotheses

The proposed framework (Figure 1) focuses on the relationship between social media marketing activities and consumers' responses; brand equity and brand loyalty and the mediation role played by brand trust. Social media is evolving on the platform of Web 2.0 characterizes by interactivity (Kaplan & Haenlein, 2010). The marketing communication tools have been developed and then shifted from the traditional focusing on push messaging to tradigital marketing channels that improve interactivity but retain the vertical flow of power in both the communication and distribution

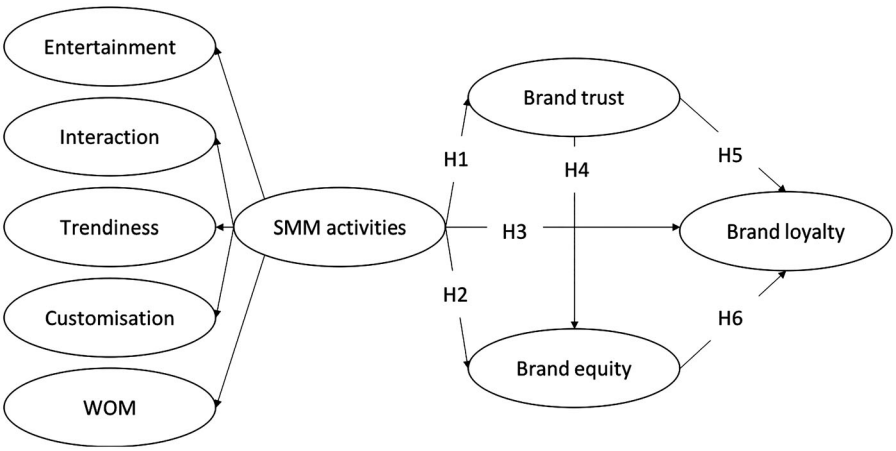


Figure 1. Proposed conceptual model.

channels. Both the traditional and tradigital marketing are based on the interruption-disruption model. While, social media channels focus on pull messaging or attraction orientation (Tuten & Solomon, 2017). Social media marketing is more like an augmentation to traditional and tradigital marketing communication tools rather than a substitute or replacement (Tuten & Solomon, 2017). Consumers are thus shifting from the traditional media to social media that empowers them and gives them a voice (Bruhn et al., 2012). They are using social network sites to search for information about the brand, interact with other brand users and share their experiences (Kozinets, de Valck, Wojnicki, & Wilner, 2010). The effectiveness of social media is then reflected on the overall performance of companies and enhance their competitiveness (Chan & Guillet, 2011). It is difficult to assess the return of companies' social media activities; however, its effectiveness can be measured through the behavioral responses of users (Pentina et al., 2013). Social media is related to relationship marketing with the focus of connecting with customers (Knoblich, Martin, Nash, & Stansbie, 2017) that creates value to the business (Chahal & Rani, 2017). This framework proposes the perceived social media marketing activities as communication tools used to stimulate the value of the brand and consumer behavior.

In the traditional marketing, companies are using communication tools to stimulate consumer's perception and associations toward the brand. Through the social media companies can raise awareness, reach new customers and enhance their brand image, which contributes to the brand value (Godey et al., 2016). The various and diversified activities of social media marketing are thus assumed to influence the different components of customer-based brand equity (Pham & Gammoh, 2015). The influence of social media marketing activities on customer equity is supported (Godey et al., 2016; Kim & Ko, 2012; Seo & Park, 2018; Yadav & Rahman, 2017).

Social media marketing is considered an effective tool for developing relationships with the customers (Choi, Fowler, Goh, & Yuan, 2016; Ismail, 2017). Additionally, such interactions will build trust and eliminate the uncertainty that might prohibit the customers from engaging with the brand (Khadim et al., 2018), and make online transactions (Chahal & Rani, 2017). Social media is perceived by consumers as sources of information, its trustworthy is functional to marketing practices. Tatar and Eren-Erdogmus (2016) supported in their study the positive influence of social media marketing charactersitics on brand trust. Companies are utilizing the social media platform to communicate, interact and engage with customers, delivering value and experiences, and thus enhance their behavioral responses toward the brand. Consumers' perceptions of the marketing activities practiced on the online context can enhance their reposes. The positive effect of social media marketing activities on brand loyalty has

been demonstrated empirically (e.g., Ismail, 2017). These online practices are the brand stimuli shaping consumers experiences and enhancing their relationship with the brands which in turn influence their responses depicted by preferences, intentions and loyalty (Laroche, Habibi, Richard, & Sankaranarayanan, 2012).

H1: SMM activities will have a positive direct impact on brand trust.

H2: SMM activities will have a positive direct impact on brand equity.

H3: SMM activities will have a positive direct impact on brand loyalty.

In the online context, trust is highly required compared to face to face interactions. It reflects consumers' willingness to engage in online interactions and participate in social media (Pentina et al., 2013). In relationship marketing, trust is required to initiate and maintain a relationship, it evolves from prior experiences and contributes in building knowledge and brand associations. Accordingly, it reinforces the company's assets exhibited by the brand equity (Ambler 1997; Delgado-Ballester & Munuera-Alemán, 2005). Users with high levels of trust are more likely willing to engage in social media and denote higher involvement in brand's social media activities which ultimately contribute to the brand value (Chahal & Rani, 2017). The beliefs on the social media attributes influence consumer's behaviors, trust is considered as mediator of the relationship between social media marketing activities and behavioral intentions (Kim & Park, 2013).

Yoo and Donthu (2001) perceive early the rebuying intentions and being loyal as a dimension of the brand endowed value. However, Chaudhuri and Holbrook (2001) argue that brand equity refers to consumer willingness to pay price premium for a valued brand; thus, it demands great favorable attitudes leading to behavioral loyalty as an outcome. The two aspects of brand equity: the firm-related view emphasizing the financial value of the brand or the consumer-based referring to perceptions of brand associations, are followed by behavioral intentions. There is a positive relationship between brand equity and brand loyalty stimulated by consumers trust on the brand value (Keller, 1993; Lassar et al., 1995).

H4: Brand trust has a positive direct impact on brand equity

H5: Brand trust has a positive direct impact on brand loyalty

H6: Brand equity has a positive direct impact on brand loyalty

Research methodology

Data collection

The primary data was collected using self-administrated online questionnaire, all the items were developed and adapted from the literature review.

The items were revised by a panel of experts and non-experts, through a pilot test, to assess the face and content validity of the measurement items. The questionnaire consists of two main sections; the first section investigated personal information and background information of users on social media, and the second section, divided into four subsections, measured the items of the constructs for testing the hypotheses. The constructs are clearly defined prior the measurement items, are displayed separately on different sections and then published online using SurveyHero. The settings of software were adjusted to remind participants of any unanswered questions before being exposed to the next. The study targeted Egyptian users on the social media context, over the period of three months from August to October of year 2019. The link of the survey was sent to selected users and posted on social media pages of the Telecommunication companies. At the beginning, the response rate was relatively low, so the survey was sent again to another batch of users.

The sample size was determined by depending on the requirements of the statistical tool used in the analysis; SEM and accordingly a sample size of 200 is accepted. A total number of 287 valid responses were obtained, constituting including 157 male and 130 female respondents and encompassing social media users of different ages, education and occupation levels. The standard mean of age is 2.5 where the majority of respondents, 69.5% were under 40. A summary of the sample characteristics is provided in Table 2. The respondents were asked to choose one of the four telecommunication companies they are fan of or follow on any social media channel. 70.7% of the respondents are on Facebook and Twitter. All the variables were measured using 7-point Likert scale with the same anchors ranged from (1) very strongly disagree to (7) very strongly agree. In order to measure respondents perceived activities on different social media channels and its provided value, the study depended on the eleven-items scale of social media marketing activities developed by (Kim & Ko, 2012). This scale addresses the five identified dimensions of SMM activities. Brand trust is measured by 5-items adopted from (Chahal & Rani, 2017). The 4-items measuring brand equity are based on Delgado-Ballester & Munuera-Alemán (2005) and brand trust is captured using 4-items (Chaudhuri & Holbrook, 2001).

Data analysis

Exploratory factor analysis

This study used SPSS version 22.0 and AMOS version 18 to analyze the data and test the hypotheses. To test the dimensionality of social media marketing activities, exploratory factor analysis (EFA) with principal

Table 2. Sample characteristics.

Demographics		
	Frequency	Percentage
Gender		
Male	157	54.7
Female	130	45.3
Age		
18–20	89	31
21–30	73	25.4
31–40	38	13.2
41–50	58	20.2
51–60	22	7.7
60+	7	2.4
Median age in Egypt is 24.6		
Gender ratio in Egypt is 1.02 (CAPMAS, 2019)		
Education		
Bachelor degree	183	63.8
Master degree	22	7.7
Doctoral degree	9	3.1
Other	73	25.4
Occupation		
Employed	151	52.6
Non-employed	19	6.6
Student	85	29.6
Housewife	32	11.1
Social media usage period		
Less than a year	27	9.4
1–5 years	69	24
6–10 years	146	50.9
More than 10 years	45	15.7
Frequency visit		
Daily	12	4.2
Weekly	6	2.1
Monthly	40	13.9
Every 3 months	14	4.9
At need	208	72.5
Never	7	2.4
Social media site		
Facebook	141	49.1
Twitter	62	21.6
Instagram	37	12.9
LinkedIn	16	5.6
YouTube	31	10.8

component analysis (PCA) and VARIMAX orthogonal rotation was used. According to Field (2005), items should be deleted if it has low communalities less than 0.5 or load on two or more factors with values greater than 0.4 are subject to deletion. All the eleven items of social media marketing activities loaded successfully on five factors. By conducting EFA on other constructs, the results show that all items loaded on three factors representing brand trust, brand equity, and brand loyalty. Only one item used to measure brand equity and another item used to measure brand loyalty were deleted because of low communality. The reliability of the factors was assessed using Cronbach alpha to measure the internal consistency, the results ranged from 0.784 to 0.93 indicating that all the factors are highly reliable.

Measurement model

The validity of the measurement model was assessed using confirmatory factor analysis (CFA), maximum likelihood estimation techniques. The measurement model includes all the constructs in the conceptual model; SMM activities, brand trust, brand equity, and brand loyalty. The first run of the measurement model show satisfactory fit indices, with $\chi^2 = 298$, df $= 84$, $p = .000$, AFGI $= 0.834$, GFI $= 0.9$, NFI $= 0.9$, IFI $= 0.9$, and CFI $= 0.91$. The root mean-square error of approximation (RMSEA) is above the upper confidence interval of 0.05. The low value of SRMR is less than 1.0 close to 0.09 is a favorable value representing a reasonable fit of a good model (Kline, 2015). Also, all factors yield acceptable standardized loading except these two dimensions of SMM: entertainment and interaction. After the deletion of these two dimensions, all the standardized loadings are above 0.5 and the constructs displays good composite reliability of 0.7 and above with significant t-values. The convergent validity of all the constructs in the measurement model was validated as indicated by the summarized results on Table 3. The results also show that the AVE is greater than the squared inter-construct correlations loading indicating acceptable discriminant validity, as shown in Table 4.

Structural model and hypotheses testing

The SEM is specified by 6 structural relationships depicted by 6 path estimates linking the relationships between the four constructs identified in the proposed model. The results yield an adequate level of fit with $X^2 = 156$, $df = 48$, $p = .000$, AFGI $= 0.87$, GFI $= 0.92$, NFI $= 0.9$, IFI $= 0.92$, RMSEA$= 0.08$ and CFI $= 0.94$. By diagnosing the path estimates, hypotheses were supported by critical values less than 0.05 level of significance at t-value $= 1.96$. Table 5 provides a summary of hypotheses testing. With regard to the three paths representing the impact of SMM activities on brand trust (H_1), brand equity (H_2), and brand loyalty (H_3). SMM activities exerts a direct positive significant impact on brand trust and brand loyalty with a path estimate of 0.23 and 0.17 and at a significance level of $p = 0.000$ and 0.000, respectively. Accordingly, the results provide support for H_1 and H_3. However, the data reveals the insignificance of the path estimate of 0.071 at p-value $= 0.218$ between SMM activities and brand equity; thus, rejecting H_2. The analysis reveals the significant positive direct impact of brand trust on both brand equity (0.627, $p = 0.000$) and brand loyalty (0.231, $p = 0.005$). Therefore, hypotheses H_4 and H_5 were supported. As anticipated in H_6 brand equity positively and significantly influence brand loyalty. Further analysis of the data indicates the existence of mediation, it shows the significance of the indirect impact of SMM activities on brand equity mediated by brand trust (0.15, $p = 0.009$). Thus, it suggests the full

Table 3. Validity and reliability test for measurement model.

Constructs	Mean	Std. dev.	Stand. Reg. weights	CR	Cronbach alpha
Social Media Marketing				0.74	0.720
Trendiness			0.504		0.864
The contents shown in the social media of this company is up to date	4.5	1.04			
The use of social media by this company is trendy	4.4	1.15			
Customization			0.938		0.784
The information that I need can be found in the social media of this company	4.1	1.08			
This company's social media provides customized service	4.2	1.03			
WOM			0.625		0.848
I would like to pass along information on the company's services from its social media to my friends	4.1	1.19			
I would like to upload contents from the social media of the company on my blog, Facebook page, Twitter.	4.1	1.20			
Brand trust				0.93	0.930
This company is honest	4.6	1.04	0.861		
This company works for my happiness	4.5	1.09	0.889		
This company works hard to satisfy me	4.5	1.14	0.901		
This company's promises are real	4.6	1.11	0.857		
Brand equity				0.83	0.821
Even if another company has the same offers as this one, I would prefer the offers of this company	4.7	1.04	0.751		
If there is another company as good as this one, I prefer this company	4.7	1.00	0.887		
If the services of another company is not different from this company in any way, it seems smarter to purchase this brand	4.7	0.93	0.727		
Brand loyalty				0.87	0.877
I intend to keep purchasing the services offered by this company	4.7	0.97	0.830		
I am loyal to this company	4.6	1.04	0.848		
I consider myself to be loyal to this company	4.7	0.98	0.840		

Table 4. Correlation matrix.

Constructs	SMM	Brand trust	Brand equity	Brand loyalty	AVE
SMM	1				0.552
Brand trust	0.21	1			0.865
Brand equity	0.22	0.63	1		0.74
Brand loyalty	0.3	0.46	0.48	1	0.77

Table 5. Summary of SEM results.

Constructs	Hypotheses	Standardized path estimate	Sig	
SMM	H_1: SMM → BT	0.24***	0.000	Supported
	H_2: SMM → BE	0.07	0.218	Rejected
	H_3: SMM → BL	0.17*	0.006	Supported
BT	H_4: BT → BE	0.63***	0.000	Supported
	H_5: BT → BL	0.23*	0.005	Supported
BE	H_6: BE → BL	0.30***	0.000	Supported

***$p < 0.000$ (99%).
*$p < 0.05$ (95%).

mediation of brand trust on controlling the relationship between SMM activities and brand equity. The indirect path estimate between SMM activities and brand loyalty via brand trust is also significant at $p < 0.05$. The impact of SMM activities on brand loyalty is partially mediated by brand

trust; since, the impact of SMM activities on brand loyalty dropped from 0.17, $p = 0.006$ in direct relationship to 0.12, $p = 0.04$ with the control of brand trust.

Discussion

Theoretical implications

The findings of this study provide several insights that contribute to the growing body of literature in social media marketing by addressing the role of SMM activities in enhancing important branding goals including brand equity and brand loyalty. Firstly, the measurement and conceptualization of SMM is still challenging (Godey et al., 2016). The used measurement scale of SMM activities developed by Kim and Ko (2012) was supported by several studies in the prior literature validating the five dimensions of social media. The holistic impact of these dimensions defines the activities motivating users toward the use of social media. However, the results obtained in this study specify only three dimensions, namely trendiness, customization and WOM. From the consumer point of view, users are engaged in the online of platforms to get tailored services and obtain latest information while they share their experiences and other recommendations. Secondly, SMM enhances brand loyalty, the three identified attributes of SMM are among other drivers of loyalty in the online context (Srinivasan et al., 2002). Loyal customers with positive attitudes holding revisiting intentions toward an online platform are triggered by updated, trendy and information-based media. unlike previous studies, the direct relationship between SMM activities and brand equity is insignificant. Thirdly, the role of trust in social media is emphasized in this study by the significant direct impact of SMM activities on brand trust. Also, trust has a mediating role in the proposed conceptual mode; a full mediation role in the relationship between SMM activities and brand equity and a partial mediation in the relationship between SMM activities and brand loyalty. Social media marketing is a communication tool used to engage consumers' and deliver valuable information about the brands. Due to breaching of user privacy and sharing information trust has a focal role in the use of and the intensity of participation in social media (Pentina et al., 2013). Therefore, consumers need to trust the digital content, trust is subsequently developed through their various experiences in social media. Consequently, trust is a key factor in creating positive brand associations and long-term relationships. In the relationship marketing, trust is the catalyst for establishing and maintaining long-term relationship, and the proxy to equity that leads to the unique, differentiated brand value carved in consumers' mind.

Managerial implications

Social media marketing is an integral part of online marketing strategies that enhances the brand performance. it is associated with customer-relationship marketing and its positive influences on customer loyalty and therefore generating more sales and profit. This study draws managerial attention to the effectiveness of social media marketing in engaging customers and encouraging their emotional and behavioral responses. The findings of the study identify the mechanisms upon which marketers depend in engaging their customers. The identified attributes of SMM are thus offering insights to these mechanisms. The primary concern of companies is to personalize the same service activities delivered to the customers per their preferences. Therefore, users can be identified within their brand communities and exhilarated toward other activities. Social media is an important source of information that influences consumers purchasing decisions. The companies should utilize the social media and other online applications to provide consumers with the latest, relevant and freshly information. This information is thus inspiring and motivating customers toward their brand choice (Yadav & Rahman, 2018). The social media facilitate the sharing of experiences, exchange of opinions and recommendations among customers and contributes heavily in the acceleration of other aspects related to WOM. The management of social media marketing will cultivate the brand community upon which customers rely on as an important source of information in decision-making. This motivating system will ultimately create the interactivity of users. The positive effects of these mechanism are subject to the customers' degree of confidence or trust in the published online content. Companies must consider controlling the digital content and other online publications, and are willing to share their experiences and exchange opinions. To increase the trustworthy of the generated content customers can be invited by the companies to share the reasons behind selecting the brand and provide them with further suggestions for improvements and developments.

Limitations and future research

This study is not without limitations. The study depends on non-probability sampling technique and the focus on one geographical area; Egypt. The sample size is relatively small; however, it is demographically representative which may provide confidence in the generalizability of the results. Few items have been dropped from the measurement thus questioning the validity of the used measurement scale of social media marketing activities. Additionally, the study examined the impact of social media marketing activities and ignore the distinguishable characteristics of

each media platform. These limitations can be considered in further future research.

References

Alalwan, A. A., Rana, N., Dwivedi, Y., & Algharabat, R. (2017). Social media in marketing: A review and analysis of the existing literature. *Telematics and Informatics*, *34*(7), 1117–1190. doi:10.1016/j.tele.2017.05.008

Ambler, T. (1997). How much of brand equity is explained by trust? *Management Decision*, *35*(4), 283–292. doi:10.1108/00251749710169666

Barefoot, D., & Szabo, J. (2010). *Friends with benefits: A social media marketing handbook* (1st ed.). San Francisco, CA: No Starch Press.

Berthon, P. R., Pitt, L., Plangger, K., & Shapiro, D. (2012). Marketing meets Web 2.0, social media, and creative consumers: Implications for international marketing strategy. *Business Horizons*, *55*(3), 261–271. doi:10.1016/j.bushor.2012.01.007

Bilgin, Y. (2018). The effect of social media marketing activities on brand awareness, brand image and brand loyalty. *Business & Management Studies: An International Journal*, *6*(1), 128–148. doi:10.15295/BMIJ.V6I1.229

Boyd, D. M., & Ellison, N. (2007). Social network sites: Definition, history, and scholarship. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, *13*(1), 210–230. doi:10.1111/j.1083-6101.2007.00393.x

Bruhn, M., Schoenmueller, V., & Schäfer, D. (2012). Are social media replacing traditional media in terms of brand equity creation? *Management Research Review*, *35*(9), 770–790. doi:10.1108/01409171211255948

Calefato, F., Lanubile, F., & Novielli, N. (2015). The role of social media in affective trust building in customer–supplier relationships. *Electronic Commerce Research*, *15*(4), 453–482. doi:10.1007/s10660-015-9194-3

CAPMAS. (2019). Retrieved from https://www.capmas.gov.eg/Pages/ShowPDF.aspx?page_id=https://censusinfo.capmas.gov.eg.

Chahal, H., & Rani, A. (2017). How trust moderates social media engagement and brand equity. *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing*, *11*(3), 312–335. doi:10.1108/JRIM-10-2016-0104

Chan, N. L., & Guillet, B. (2011). Investigation of social media marketing: How does the hotel industry in Hong Kong perform in marketing on social media websites? *Journal of Travel & Tourism Marketing*, *28*, 345–368. doi:10.1080/10548408.2011.571571

Chang, Y.-T., Yu, H., & Lu, H.-P. (2015). Persuasive messages, popularity cohesion, and message diffusion in social media marketing. *Journal of Business Research*, *68*(4), 777–782. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2014.11.027

Chaudhuri, A., & Holbrook, M. (2001). The chain of effects from brand trust and brand affect to brand performance: The role of brand loyalty. *Journal of Marketing*, *65*(2), 81–93. April). doi:10.1509/jmkg.65.2.81.18255

Chen, S.-C., & Lin, C.-P. (2019). Understanding the effect of social media marketing activities: The mediation of social identification, perceived value, and satisfaction. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, *140*, 22–32. doi:10.1016/j.techfore.2018.11.025

Chi, H.-H. (2011). Interactive digital advertising Vs. virtual brand community: Exploratory study of user motivation and social media marketing responses in Taiwan. *Journal of Interactive Advertising*, *12*(1), 44–61. doi:10.1080/15252019.2011.10722190

Choi, E.-K., Fowler, D., Goh, B., & Yuan, J. (2016). Social media marketing: Applying the uses and gratifications theory in the hotel industry. *Journal of Hospitality Marketing & Management*, *25*(7), 771–796. doi:10.1080/19368623.2016.1100102

CMO. (2018). *The CMO survey*. Retrieved from www.cmosurvey.org.

Dann, S. (2010). Redefining social marketing with contemporary commercial marketing definitions. *Journal of Business Research*, *63*(2), 147–153. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2009.02.013

Delgado-Ballester, E., & Munuera-AlemáN, J. (2005). Does brand trust matter to brand equity? *Journal of Product & Brand Management*, *14*(3), 187–196.

Doney, P. M., & Cannon, J. (1997). April). An examination of the nature of trust in buyer-seller relationships. *Journal of Marketing*, *61*, 35–51. doi:10.2307/1251829

Duffett, R. G. (2015). Facebook advertising's influence on intention-to-purchase and purchase amongst Millennials. *Internet Research*, *25*(4), 498–2243. doi:10.1108/IntR-01-2014-0020

Dwivedi, Y. K., Kapoor, K., & Chen, H. (2015). Social media marketing and advertising. *The Marketing Review*, *15*(3), 289–309. doi:10.1362/146934715X14441363377999

Felix, R., Rauschnabel, P., & Hinsch, C. (2017). Elements of strategic social media marketing: A holistic framework. *Journal of Business Research*, *70*, 118–126. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2016.05.001

Field, A. (2005). *Discovering statistics using SPSS* (2nd edition). London, Sage Publications Ltd. ISBN-10: 9780761944522

Gautam, V., & Sharma, V. (2017). The mediating role of customer relationship on the social media marketing and purchase intention relationship with special reference to luxury fashion brands. *Journal of Promotion Management*, *23*(6), 872–888. doi:10.1080/10496491.2017.1323262

Gensler, S., Völckner, F., Liu-Thompkins, Y., & Wiertz, C. (2013). Managing brands in the social media environment. *Journal of Interactive Marketing*, *27*(4), 242–256. doi:10.1016/j.intmar.2013.09.004

Godey, B., Manthiou, A., Pederzoli, D., Rokka, J., Aiello, G., Donvito, R., & Singh, R. (2016). Social media marketing efforts of luxury brands: Influence on brand equity and consumer behavior. *Journal of Business Research*, *69*(12), 5833–5841. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2016.04.181

Granovetter, M. (1985). Economic action and social structure: The problem of embeddedness. The *American Journal of Sociology*, *91*(3), 481–510. doi:10.1086/228311

Ismail, A. R. (2017). The influence of perceived social media marketing activities on brand loyalty: The mediation effect of brand and value consciousness. *Asia Pacific Journal of Marketing and Logistics*, *29*(1), 129–144. doi:10.1108/APJML-10-2015-0154

Jakic, A., Wagner, M., & Meyer, A. (2017). The impact of language style accommodation during social media interactions on brand trust. *Journal of Service Management*, *28*(3), 418–441. doi:10.1108/JOSM-12-2016-0325

Kaplan, A. M., & Haenlein, M. (2010). Users of the world, unite! The challenges and opportunities of Social Media. *Business Horizons*, *53*(1), 59–68. doi:10.1016/j.bushor.2009.09.003

Keller, K. L. (1993). Conceptualizing, measuring, and managing customer-based brand equity. *Journal of Marketing*, *57*(1), 1–22. doi:10.1177/002224299305700101

Khadim, R. A., Hanan, M., Arshad, A., Saleem, N., & Khadim, N. (2018). Revisiting antecedents of brand loyalty: Impact of perceived social media communication with brand trust and brand equity as mediators. *Academy of Strategic Management Journal*, *17*(1), 1–14.

Khong, K. W., Onyemeh, N. C., & Chong, A. Y. L. (2013). BSEM estimation of network effect and customer orientation empowerment on trust in social media and network

environment. *Expert Systems with Applications*, *40*(12), 4858–4870. doi:10.1016/j.eswa.2013.02.020

Kim, A. J., & Ko, E. (2010). Impacts of luxury fashion brand's social media marketing on customer relationship and purchase intention. *Journal of Global Fashion Marketing*, *1*(3), 164–171. doi:10.1080/20932685.2010.10593068

Kim, A. J., & Ko, E. (2012). Do social media markeitng activities enhance customer equity? An empirical study of luxury fashion brand. *Journal of Business Research*, *65*(10), 1480–1486. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2011.10.014

Kim, S., & Park, H. (2013). Effects of various characteristics of social commerce (s-commerce) on consumers' trust and trust performance. *International Journal of Information Management*, *33*(2), 318–332. doi:10.1016/j.ijinfomgt.2012.11.006

Kline, R. (2015). *Principles and practice of strucutral equation modeling*. New York, United States, Guilford Publications. ISBN-13:9781462523344

Knoblich, S., Martin, A., Nash, R., & Stansbie, P. (2017). Keys to success in social media marketing (SMM) – Prospects for the German airline industry. *Tourism and Hospitality Research*, *17*(2), 147–164. doi:10.1177/1467358415610415

Kozinets, R. V., de Valck, K., Wojnicki, A., & Wilner, S. (2010). Networked narratives: Understanding word-of-mouth marketing in online communities. *Journal of Marketing*, *74*(2), 71–89. doi:10.1509/jmkg.74.2.71

Laroche, M., Habibi, M. R., Richard, M.-O., & Sankaranarayanan, R. (2012). The effects of social media based brand communities on brand community markers, value creation practices, brand trust and brand loyalty. *Computers in Human Behavior*, *28*(5), 1755–1767. doi:10.1016/j.chb.2012.04.016

Lassar, W., Mittal, B., & Sharma, A. (1995). Measuring customer-based brand equity. *Journal of Consumer Marketing*, *12*(4), 11–19. doi:10.1108/07363769510095270

Mohammadpour, A., Arbatani, T., Gholipour, T., Farzianpour, F., & Hosseini, S. (2014). A survey of the effect of social media marketing on online shopping of customers by mediating variables. *Journal of Service Science and Management*, *07*(05), 368–376. doi:10.4236/jssm.2014.75034

Pentina, I., Zhang, L., & Basmanova, O. (2013). Antecedents and consequences of trust in a social media brand: A cross-cultural study of Twitter. *Computers in Human Behavior*, *29*(4), 1546–1555. doi:10.1016/j.chb.2013.01.045

Pham, P. H., & Gammoh, B. (2015). Characteristics of social-media marketing strategy and customer-based brand equity outcomes: A conceptual model. *International Journal of Internet Marketing and Advertising*, *9*(4), 321–337. doi:10.1504/IJIMA.2015.072885

Ridings, C. M., Gefen, D., & Arinze, B. (2002). Some antecedents and effects of trust in virtual communities. *The Journal of Strategic Information Systems*, *11*(3–4), 271–295. doi:10.1016/S0963-8687(02)00021-5

Sano, K. (2014). Do social media marketing activities enhance customer satisfaction, promote positive WOM and affect behavior intention? An investigation into the effects of social media on the tourism industry. *Investment Effect Social media Tour India*, *66*(3–4), 45–69.

Schmidt, K. N., & Iyer, M. K. S. (2015). Online behaviour of social media participants' and perception of trust, comparing social media brand community groups and associated organized marketing strategies. *Procedia-Social and Behavioral Sciences*, *177*, 432–439. doi:10.1016/j.sbspro.2015.02.389

Schultz, D. E., & Peltier, J. (2013). Social media's slippery slope: Challenges, opportunities and future research directions. *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing*, *7*(2), 86–99. doi:10.1108/JRIM-12-2012-0054

Seo, E.-J., & Park, J.-W. (2018). A study on the effects of social media marketing activities on brand equity and customer response in the airline industry. *Journal of Air Transport Management*, *66*, 36–41. doi:10.1016/j.jairtraman.2017.09.014

Srinivasan, S. S., Anderson, R., & Ponnavolu, K. (2002). Customer loyalty in e-commerce: An exploration of its antecedents and consequences. *Journal of Retailing*, *78*(1), 41–50. doi:10.1016/S0022-4359(01)00065-3

Srivastrava, R. K., & Shocker, A. D. (1991). *Brand Equity: A Perspective on I is Meaning and Measurement*. Cambridge, MA: Marketing Science Institute, (October), Report, (91–124).

Tatar, S. B., & Eren-Erdogmus, I. (2016). The effect of social media marketing on brand trust and brand loyalty for hotels. *Information Technology & Tourism*, *16*(3), 249–263. doi:10.1007/s40558-015-0048-6

Taubenheim, A., Long, T., Smith, E., Jeffers, D., Wayman, J., & Temple, S. (2008). Using social media and internet marketing to reach women with the heart truth. *Social Marketing Quarterly*, *14*(3), 58–67. doi:10.1080/15245000802279433

Taylor, S. A., Celuch, K., & Goodwin, S. (2004). The importance of brand equity to customer loyalty. The *Journal of Product & Brand Management*, *13*(4), 217–227. doi:10.1108/10610420410546934

Tuten, T. L. (2008). Advertising 2.0: Social media marketing in a web 2.0 world, *Praeger Publishers*.

Tuten, T. L., & Solomon, M. (2017). *Social media marketing*. London, United Kingdom, Sage Publications Ltd.

Valck, K. d., van Bruggen, G., & Wierenga, B. (2009). Virtual communities: A marketing perspective. *Decision Support Systems*, *47*(3), 185–203. doi:10.1016/j.dss.2009.02.008

Warner-Søderholm, G., Bertsch, A., Sawe, E., Lee, D., Wolfe, T., Meyer, J., … Fatilua, U. N. (2018). Who trusts social media? *Computers in Human Behavior*, *81*, 303–315. doi:10.1016/j.chb.2017.12.026

Warner-Søderholm, G., Bertsch, A., Sawe, E., Lee, D., Wolfe, T., Meyer, J., … Fatilua, U. N. (2018). Who trusts social media? *Computers in Human Behavior Journal*, *81*, 303–335. doi:10.1016/j.chb.2017.12.026

Yadav, M., & Rahman, Z. (2017). Measuring consumer perception of social media marketing activities in e-commerce industry: Scale development & validation. *Telematics and Informatics*, *34*, 1294–1307. doi:10.1016/j.tele.2017.06.001

Yadav, M., & Rahman, Z. (2018). The influence of social media marketing activities on customer loyalty: A study of e-commerce industry. *Benchmarking: An International Journal*, *25*(9), 3882–3905. doi:10.1108/BIJ-05-2017-0092

Yoo, B., & Donthu, N. (2001). Developing and validating a multidimensional consumer-based brand equity scale. *Journal of Business Research*, *52*(1), 1–14. doi:10.1016/S0148-2963(99)00098-3

Zaglia, M. E. (2013). Brand communities embedded in social networks. *Journal of Business Research*, *66*(2), 216–223. doi:10.1016/j.jbusres.2012.07.015